

The Evidence - Mumbai London AF Clinic

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THE EVIDENCE

Whatever the machine, it is safer in experienced hands.

You may have been offered PFA - pulsed field ablation - because it is a newer way to treat atrial fibrillation. RFA - radiofrequency ablation - uses carefully controlled heat; PFA uses short electrical pulses instead. Both treat the same small areas of heart tissue that trigger AF.

In 2025, large trials directly comparing the two reported their results: PFA and RFA performed broadly comparably; the right choice depends on the patient.¹

The number that does change your outcome.

Across published studies, one factor shows up again and again: how often the centre - and the doctor - performs the procedure.²

2.1%

Lower-volume centres

0.9%

Higher-volume centres

Major complication rates after AF ablation, by centre volume.² 4 Published research consistently finds lower complication rates where more of these procedures are done.

What this means for you.

The right question is not “which technology?” It is “who is holding the catheter?” Professor Gupta offers both RFA and PFA, and chooses the right tool for each patient.

His numbers, in context.

200+ ablations a year, every year since 2009 - a high-volume UK operator.³

A published complication rate below 1%.³

More than 5,000 procedures across his career.

Your questions, plainly answered.

Is PFA newer and therefore better?

PFA (pulsed field ablation) is newer, but newer does not automatically mean better. In the largest studies directly comparing the two, published in 2025, PFA and RFA (radiofrequency ablation) produced broadly comparable results.¹ What consistently makes the biggest difference to safety and success in published research is the experience of the doctor performing the procedure.²

Is catheter ablation safe?

Catheter ablation is a routine, well-established procedure carried out hundreds of thousands of times a year worldwide. Like any procedure it carries some risk, and your doctor will explain those risks for your situation. Published research shows complication rates are lower at centres and with doctors who perform a high volume of these procedures.² Professor Gupta's published complication rate is below 1%.³

Which technology will I get - RFA or PFA?

Professor Gupta is trained and experienced in both. Neither is right for every patient. He will assess your heart, your history and your preferences, explain the options in plain language, and recommend the one that suits you - not the one that happens to be available.

How long does recovery take?

Most patients go home the same day or the next morning, and are back to normal light activity within a few days. Your care team will give you clear, written instructions for the first weeks, and follow-up is arranged with a trusted local cardiologist under Professor Gupta's supervision.

Do I need to travel to the UK?

No. Consultations and procedures take place in Mumbai during Professor Gupta's scheduled visits. Between visits, your follow-up happens locally, coordinated with cardiologists he works with - so you are never without a doctor close to home.

What happens at the first consultation?

An unhurried conversation. Professor Gupta will review your history, any recordings or scans you have, and explain what is happening in your heart in plain language - in English, Hindi or Punjabi. You will leave with a clear plan, whether or not that plan includes a procedure.

Book a consultation

References

Head-to-head randomised comparison of PFA vs RFA for paroxysmal AF, 2025.

Volume-outcome relationship in catheter ablation of atrial fibrillation: systematic review.

Published single-operator complication-rate series, Liverpool Heart and Chest Hospital.

National registry data on AF ablation complication rates by centre volume.

Take the first step. It costs nothing to ask.

Send a short enquiry and the clinic team will come back to you, or message us directly on WhatsApp.

Message on WhatsApp

Your name

Phone (with country code)

Briefly, what is the problem?

Send enquiry

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Mumbai London AF Clinic

London expertise. Mumbai care. Continuous follow-up.

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Professor Dhiraj Gupta is registered with the UK General Medical Council (GMC no. 0000000 [placeholder]).

Information on this site is for general education and is not a substitute for individual medical advice. Always consult a doctor about your own condition.

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